

↳ There are two types of Surahs:

1. Makki' Surah → Talks about belief
2. Medni Surah → Talks about laws & regulation

What is taqwa?

↳ Muhammad Umar (RA) explained beautifully:

- Taqwa is like walking on a path that is full of thorns or nails. If you walk on that path, you must be careful and aware, lifting your clothes and avoiding the thorns, so they do not hurt you. This is how you should live your life—careful, mindful, and avoiding things that could harm your soul.

Surah Al Hujurat:
↳ Apartments

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا لَا تَقْدَمُوا بَيْنَ يَدَيِ اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ سَوِّتَقُوا اللَّهَ إِنَّ اللَّهَ سَمِيعٌ عَلِيمٌ ۝١

O believers! Do not proceed 'in any matter' before 'a decree from' Allah and His Messenger. And fear Allah. Surely Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing. [49:01]

↳ Believers should not act hastily or impulsively without first considering the guidance of Allah and teachings of Prophet (sws).

↳ Referring to above, Allah says that our actions align with his will because he can see & hear everything.

O believers! Do not raise your voices above the voice of the Prophet, nor speak loudly to him as you do to one another, or your deeds will become void while you are unaware. [49:02]

Indeed, those who lower their voices in the presence of Allah's Messenger are the ones whose hearts Allah has refined for righteousness. They will have forgiveness and a great reward. [49:03]

Indeed, most of those who call out to you 'O Prophet' from outside 'your' private quarters ^{by his name} have no understanding 'of manners'. [49:04]

Had they been patient until you could come out to them, it would have certainly been better for them. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful. [49:05]

↳ However, if they do what is described, then no issue because Allah is forgiving and most merciful.

↳ In modern world, this means to wait outside someone's door till 3 knocks

O believers, if an evildoer brings you any news, verify 'it' so you do not harm people unknowingly, becoming regretful for what you have done. [49:06]

↳ This is reference to a story, when a sahabat was sent by prophet (sws) to collect Zakat from a tribe. However, when he returned, he reported that he had been attacked during his mission by the tribe.

↳ Upon hearing this, some companions of prophet (sws) urged him to take immediate action against the tribe.

↳ However, the Prophet (sws) waited. The tribe's chief came forward and said that none of the members of the tribe had seen such an attack.

↳ The prophet (sws) upon hearing this found that the claim of attack had no basis.

↳ Had the prophet (sws) done as his companions wanted then there would have been a war & unnecessary death.

And keep in mind that Allah's Messenger is 'still' in your midst. If he were to yield to you in many matters, you would surely suffer 'the consequences'.¹ But Allah has endeared faith to you, making it appealing in your hearts. And He has made disbelief, rebelliousness, and disobedience detestable to you. Those are the ones rightly guided. [49:07]

↳ Sahabah used to guide prophet to take certain actions but the prophet (sws) didn't yield to him because had he then they would have surely suffered.

↳ Allah has made faith beloved and disbelief, rebelliousness, and disobedience repulsive to hearts of believers. Those who feel like this are ones rightly guided by Allah.

'This is' a bounty and a blessing from Allah. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise. [49:08]

↳ The ability to love faith and to detest disbelief is a blessing from Allah.

↳ Allah knows what is best for his creation & has granted them the guidance they need and suited their individual needs.

And if two groups of believers fight each other, then make peace between them. But if one of them transgresses against the other, then fight against the transgressing group until they 'are willing to' submit to the rule of Allah. If they do so, then make peace between both 'groups' in all fairness and act justly. Surely Allah loves those who uphold justice. [49:09]

The believers are but one brotherhood, so make peace between your brothers. And be mindful of Allah so you may be shown mercy. [49:10]

↳ This verse says that living mercifully with each other — whether by resolving conflicts peacefully, being kind, or forgiving others's wrong-doings — aligns with justice mentioned first verse.

↳ When we uphold justice, treat others with mercy, and fairness, we invite Allah's mercy on us

O believers! Do not let some 'men' ridicule others, they may be better than them, nor let 'some' women ridicule other women, they may be better than them. Do not defame one another, nor call each other by offensive nicknames. How evil it is to act rebelliously after having faith! And whoever does not repent, it is they who are the 'true' wrongdoers. [49:11]

O believers! Avoid many suspicions, 'for' indeed, some suspicions are sinful. And do not spy, nor backbite one another. Would any of you like to eat the flesh of their dead brother? You would despise that!¹ And fear Allah. Surely Allah is 'the' Acceptor of Repentance, Most Merciful. [49:12]

O humanity! Indeed, We created you from a male and a female, and made you into peoples and tribes so that you may 'get to' know one another. Surely the most noble of you in the sight of Allah is the most righteous among you. Allah is truly All-Knowing, All-Aware. [49:13]

↳ Says that All human beings share the same origin — made by Allah from a male and female — are equal regardless of their

genders.

↳ He has made people into different tribes have diversity in race, ethnicity, and culture. This is meant to bring people together in sense that they learn from one another.

↳ Allah says noble are those who are righteous and not on the basis of their wealth, status or race.

‘Some of’ the nomadic Arabs say, “We believe.” Say, ‘O Prophet, “You have not believed. But say, ‘We have submitted,’ for faith has not yet entered your hearts.¹ But if you obey Allah and His Messenger ‘wholeheartedly’, He will not discount anything from ‘the reward of’ your deeds. Allah is truly All-Forgiving, Most Merciful.” [49:14]

↳ This verse makes a distinction between outward submission and internal belief in Allah and his messengers.

↳ It says true faith (Iman) requires more than just claiming belief. It involves sincere, wholehearted commitment to obey Allah and his messengers.

↳ If they do so, Allah will reward them.

↳ Emphasizes that even if someone is in the process of strengthening their faith, Allah will still reward them for their effort and obedience, provided they remain sincere.

The ‘true’ believers are only those who believe in Allah and His Messenger—never doubting—and strive with their wealth and their lives in the cause of Allah.

They are the ones true in faith. [49:15]

Say, “Do you inform Allah of your faith, when Allah ‘already’ knows whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth? And Allah has ‘perfect’ knowledge of all things.” [49:16]

↳ Allah addresses the arrogance of those who may boast about their faith or claim to be devout in front of them.

↳ The prophet told them, “Do you think you can inform Allah of your faith as if he already knows what is in your heart?”

↳ This reiterates that Allah has knowledge of all things.

They regard their acceptance of Islam as a favour to you. Tell 'them, O Prophet',
"Do not regard your Islam as a favour to me. Rather, it is Allah Who has done you
a favour by guiding you to the faith, if 'indeed' you are faithful. [49:17]

Surely Allah knows the unseen of the heavens and earth. And Allah is All-Seeing
of what you do." [49:18]

↳ Allah knows everything, including unseen aspects of heaven and earth.

↳ This includes hidden thoughts, intentions, and actions of people.

↳ Since Allah is all-seeing, everyone is reminded that their actions and intentions are known to him.